Q+A

TURNING IT AROUND

Abhishek Bachchan's latest outing, *Ghoomer*, is more than just a film about cricket



Q. Did you approach *Ghoomer* as a sports film?
Definitely not! But I do feel sports are a lot like life—you play constantly, sometimes defensively, sometimes in attack mode, and you want to have fun. *Ghoomer* is about believing in yourself. My character, Padam Singh Sodhi, has many layers. As a coach, he wields an iron cane, but as a person, there is an emotional arc. It was a very exciting role, and the icing on the cake was being directed by R. Balki.

Q. Before the release, everyone talked about how the film may teach cricketers a thing or two...
Oh, you mean the bowling stance? Why not? Global sports history is replete with stories of people who refused to give up. And that led to new benchmarks. At the end of it, when a hurdle is overcome, victory takes over any bitterness...and that's the full circle of *Ghoomer*.

Q. You're also the film's producer. How much of a pressure is that?
I wouldn't deny it's a heavy one. At the end of the day, good cinema is a film that's successful, and a bad film is one that didn't earn money, irrespective of its core idea, emotions and techniques. We are in the business of making movies for an audience that will decide whether a film is good or not, regardless of the intentions with which it was made.

Q. What other projects are you looking forward to?
I'm stoked about *SSS 7*, a single-actor film that is Parthiban's Hindi remake of his 2019 Tamil thriller *Oththa Seruppu Size 7*. Then there is Nikkhil Advani's comedy film and Remo D'Souza's *Be Happy*.... And I'm off to the US to shoot with Shoojit Sircar. That one is also a slice-of-life drama that will definitely require I push the envelope even more.

with Aarti Kapur Singh

Photograph by **BANDEEP SINGH**